



TECHTONIC

SEASON 8

#AIAtUnilever | #TechDoneRight

Case Study

About Unilever

Unilever has spent more than a century making products people reach for without thinking. Around 3.7 billion people use its products on any given day. A shower in Jakarta, a kitchen in São Paulo, a laundry basket in Manchester, a bathroom shelf in Mumbai: somewhere in each there is usually a Unilever brand, whether Dove, Rexona, Domestos, Knorr, Lakmé, or Axe.

Unilever operates across four Business Groups: Beauty & Wellbeing, Personal Care, Home Care, Nutrition. Behind the wellness products, snacks, and beverages is something powerful: technology and data transforming Unilever as an AI-Age organisation driven by technology and data. This is driven by Global Digital & Technology (GDT). GDT is a global function that serves as the digital backbone for Unilever and plays a key role in its strategy





Background

Deep into stoppage time, with the match still level, the fourth official lifts his board to signal six more minutes. As his arms go up, the cameras catch something in the one spot on a football pitch no advertiser had ever claimed: tucked beneath his arm, a Rexona logo. It lasts barely three seconds, yet by the final whistle fans have found it for themselves, frozen the frame, and turned it into the meme of the tournament. For a Brand Manager of Rexona, this isn't just a viral clip. It is the ultimate market signal and opportunity. On the sweat-soaked, high-pressure arm of the one official who cannot afford to lose his cool, the brand is not interrupting the moment. It is the moment serving as living proof of our tagline: "It won't EVER let you down". But here is the immediate challenge.

The conventional approach to capturing cultural moments lacks agility. Between agency briefs, sentiment testing, full-scale shoots, and manual localization across multiple formats, campaign momentum is lost. By the time the content hits the market, the viral opportunity is dead.

While startups chase trends in hours, Unilever brand managers process large volumes of collected data. Despite having an arsenal of advanced technical capabilities, such as social listening, and web scraping, these functions operate independently. By the time managers manually synthesize these scattered insights, the window of opportunity has closed. The challenge is not simply to build a unified dashboard, but to fundamentally transform how we synchronize and act on consumer intelligence across a brand ecosystem.



The Challenge

The modern marketing ecosystem demands an unprecedented volume of content and real-time decision-making. Yet, brand managers find themselves increasingly overwhelmed by fragmented data, disconnected dashboards, and endless asset requests. While isolated AI experiments exist across various departments, the core processes of brand management have yet to evolve at the same pace.

Recognizing this breaking point, imagine a forward-thinking marketing manager posing a critical challenge to their team: "We don't just need another list of standalone generative AI features," they might argue. "Our competitors will soon buy access to the exact same foundational models we use.

The real question is how we fundamentally rewire our processes. Show me the system that makes our brand teams invincible." Imagine you have been hired as the Product Manager for Project NEXT. Your mission is to reimagine how a global consumer goods company builds and manages brands from the ground up. If we were founded today in an AI-first world, how would you architect the entire brand lifecycle?

The Ask

Imagine you have been hired as the Product Manager for Project NEXT. Your mission is to reimagine how a global consumer goods company builds and manages brands from the ground up. If we were founded today in an AI first world, how would you architect the entire brand lifecycle?

As a Product Manager, your task is to:

- Redefine Digital landscape to the end-to-end brand management lifecycle and identify where AI can create value.
- Propose a portfolio of AI-powered products that could support brand teams across this lifecycle.
- Prioritize the most impactful opportunities and explain your rationale.
- Select one such opportunity/product and design it in detail, covering:
 - User journey
 - Product capabilities
 - AI technologies and agents
 - Architecture and governance
 - Human oversight
 - Costs and implementation roadmap
 - Demonstrate your vision through prototypes, mockups, agents, or live demonstrations.

The ask is not simply to propose new foundational models, but to recommend meaningful changes to the process.

Evaluation Criteria

Evaluation Criteria:

#	Evaluation Parameter	Weightage
1	Product Thinking (Vertical)	25%
2	Ecosystem Thinking (Horizontal)	20%
3	AI & Technical Feasibility	20%
4	Opportunity Prioritization	15%
5	Business Impact & Value Creation	15%
6	Creativity & Prototype	5%

Submission Guidelines:

Please submit your proposal in three slides: Synopsis and Analysis of the problem statement (based on your understanding), proposed portfolio using relevant technology with product and area of solution, product in depth with cost estimates, build timelines, etc.

Notes:

- You may propose partnerships with startups or third-party tech providers.
- You need to use real-world examples, mock-ups, or prototypes/ functional agent demonstration to strengthen your pitch. Submissions without a prototype will not be considered.